Page	Solicitation Reference	Question/Comment	Responses
23-28	FAR 52.219 / Limitations on Subcontracting / 8(a) Conditions	Is teaming, Joint Venture (JV) or subcontracting permitted under this solicitation? If yes, are there any restrictions or limitations applicable to subcontractors?	Yes, the limitations in accordance with FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting apply.
19	7.0 Key Personnel	Are resumes required at the time of proposal submission? If yes, please clarify whether resumes are required only for the Key Personnel identified in Section 7 (Project Manager, Power Apps Developer, and Power BI Developer), or if offerors are expected to propose additional named resources as part of the proposal submission. Please also confirm the number of resumes required.	This item is governed by the RFQ instructions rather than the PWS/QASP. Follow the solicitation instructions for submission format and evaluation requirements.
23	Limitations on Subcontracting	For the Prime Contractor to meet the 51% requirement, please clarify whether the personnel must be on the Prime Contractor's (Edify) W-2 payroll, or whether personnel from similarly situated small businesses may also be counted toward the requirement.	In order to be similarly situated, the subcontractor must also be an 8(a) firm.
19	7.0 Key Personnel	If resumes are required, should offerors provide actual named candidate resumes or representative/sample resumes?	If resumes are submitted, provide names of candidates proposed and not representative samples.
19	7.0 Key Personnel	Are Letters of Intent (LOIs) required for proposed personnel?	No.
19	7.0 Key Personnel	In the event a proposed resource becomes unavailable after proposal submission but prior to award, will candidate substitutions be permitted? If yes, please clarify any restrictions or approval process.	All resources submitted with the quote shall be available at award. If there are changes, notify the Contract Specialist immediately.
71	Factor 1 – Technical Approach	In the event resumes are required as part of proposal submission, please confirm whether resumes shall be included under Factor 1 – Technical Approach. Further, please clarify whether resumes will count toward the 25-page limitation for Factor 1 or may be submitted as separate attachments/exhibits excluding from the page count.	Resumes may be submitted as separate attachments; therefore not counted toward the total page limitation.
70–74	Instructions to Prepare Quote & Evaluation Factors	Please confirm proposal submission consists only of the three evaluation factors: Factor 1 – Technical Approach, Factor 2 – Past Performance, and Factor 3 – Price (staffing plan). Please confirm no additional proposal volumes or separate narrative sections are required.	Please review Instruction to Offerors starting on pg. 70 of the RFQ document explaining the submission requirements. Technical evaluation criteria starts on pg. 71.
72- 73	Factor 2 – Relevant Past Performance	For Past Performance references, are only Government clients acceptable, or may State, Local, and Commercial references also be submitted?	Please submit references to any contracts similar in size, scope, and complexity to support this solicitation, and a point of contact to verify reference(s).
71	2.0 Technical Acceptance Criteria And Basis For The Award	We understand Factor 1 (Technical Approach) is limited to 25 pages and Factor 2 (Past Performance) is limited to two pages total, with each individual Past Performance reference limited to one page. We further understand that Factor 3 (Price) does not have a page limitation. Please confirm our understanding is correct. Additionally, please confirm whether the 25-page limitation applies only to Factor 1 – Technical Approach or whether Past Performance content submitted under Factor 2 is included within the 25-page limitation.	The Technical Approach has a 25 Page Limit (to include all documents i.e., cover page, table of contents, etc.).

71	Factor 1 – Technical Approach	Factor 1 states that the Technical Approach shall address how the Contractor plans to accomplish the requirements in Section II – Performance Work Statement. Since Section II includes Contract Administration (4.1), Technical Support Services (4.2), and Transition-Out requirements (4.3), please confirm whether offerors are expected to address all PWS tasks under Section 4.0 or primarily Technical Support Services requirements under Sections 4.2.1–4.2.5.	Please review the criteria for Technical Approach starting on pg. 71 of the RFQ.
70	Instructions to Prepare Quote & Evaluation Factors	Please confirm whether there are any proposal formatting requirements, including font type, font size, spacing, or margin requirements.	12 point font, Times new Roman is acceptable.
70	Instructions to Prepare Quote & Evaluation Factors	Please confirm proposal submission requirements: single file or multiple files?	Multiple files is acceptable, please be sure the file is clearly marked and labeled.
71	2.0 Technical Acceptance Criteria And Basis For The Award	Please clarify whether proposal submission consists of only two files: (1) a combined submission containing Factor 1 – Technical Approach and Factor 2 – Past Performance, and (2) Factor 3 – Price, including the completed Attachment 1 – Initial Staffing Plan (Proposal Deliverable).	Please review Instruction to Offerors starting on pg. 70 of the RFQ document explaining the submission requirements.
72 - 73	Factor 2 – Relevant Past Performance	Under Past Performance requirements, are references mandatory? If yes, are Point-of-Contact (POC) details required?	Yes please provide Point-of-Contact (POC) for any references submitted.
74	Factor 3 - Price	Under Factor 3, we understand offerors are required to complete the Initial Staffing Plan attachment. Please confirm whether this is the only required pricing/staffing attachment and whether offerors may recreate the document in Excel or Word format instead of editing the PDF version provided.	The Initial Staffing Plan is its own attachment. If you need to recreate in excel or word to provide details, this is acceptable.
70	1.0 Delivery of Quotes	“The solicitation states that Offerors are required to comply with Treasury APU 26-01 in its entirety.” However, we were unable to locate the referenced attachment within the solicitation package. Please provide the document or clarify where it may be accessed.	Removed language "attached to this solicitation" for Treasury APU 26-01. The Initial Staffing Plan APU 26-01 is attached.
19	Section II – PWS Section 7	The solicitation references a written staffing plan prior to performance. Please clarify whether the Initial Staffing Plan attachment submitted with the proposal satisfies this requirement, or whether an additional staffing plan narrative is expected. If yes, the additional staffing plan narrative can be submitted after award?	The Initial Staffing Plan satisfies this requirement.
72–73	Factor 2 – Past Performance / CPARS	The solicitation notes that the Government may review CPARS information as part of the evaluation process. Please confirm whether CPARS evaluations will be used in lieu of submitted Past Performance references or in addition to them.	That is at the CS/CO discretion.
72–73	Factor 2 – Past Performance / CPARS	Please clarify whether offerors are required to identify specific CPARS contract references within the proposal submission for evaluation purposes.	The Government may also check for confirmation the Contractor Reporting Assessment Performance System (CPARS) for information on the responding contractor.
72–73	Factor 2 – Past Performance / CPARS	If CPARS will be evaluated, please confirm whether only Prime Contractor CPARS records will be considered or whether subcontractor/teaming partner CPARS records may also be submitted and evaluated.	This should be of the prime. If there are contracts in which you worked with as the subcontractor, this may also be submitted and is acceptable.
72–73	Factor 2 – Past Performance / CPARS	Please clarify whether CPARS records from task orders performed under GWACs, IDIQs, or BPA vehicles are acceptable for Past Performance evaluation.	If it is similar in size, scope, and complexity to that contemplated by the solicitation, and a point of contact to verify reference, it is acceptable.
72–73	Factor 2 – Past Performance / CPARS	Please confirm whether offerors without available CPARS history will receive a neutral confidence rating and will not be negatively impacted during evaluation. If this understanding is correct will the offeror be still considered for award?	In the case of a quoter, without a record of Past Performance or for who past performance is not available in Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS), such a quoter will receive a neutral rating for past performance.

74, 19	Factor 3 - Price/7.0 Key Personnel	Please confirm whether proposed labor categories are required to exactly match the awarded labor categories on the contractor's GSA 8(a) STARS III contract, or whether offerors may propose equivalent/mapped labor categories that align with the required skills, experience, and scope of work. If mapping is permitted, please confirm whether a labor category crosswalk is acceptable.	Yes. Offerors may propose equivalent/mapped labor categories that are on their GSA 8(a) STARS III contract. The Government does not dictate the labor mix for this PWS requirement, however is seeking the skillsets best aligned to perform the scope of work and requirements.
2	Section I – Pricing Schedule / Line Item Table	For Factor 3 – Price, please confirm whether offerors are required to complete the Line Item Table/CLIN pricing structure in addition to Attachment 1 – Initial Staffing Plan (Proposal Deliverable). If additional pricing documentation is required, please clarify all required pricing submission components.	Please review Instruction to Offerors starting on pg. 70 of the RFQ document explaining the submission requirements.
19–20	Section 7 – Key Personnel	Please confirm whether Key Personnel are required to be committed and available at the time of proposal submission or may be identified after award.	All resources submitted with the quote shall be available at award. If there are changes, notify the Contract Specialist immediately.
9	9.0 Place of Performance	The PWS identifies the primary place of performance as Contractor site (Remote Work). Please confirm whether any regular onsite presence, travel, kickoff attendance, or periodic meetings at IRS facilities are anticipated during contract performance.	Yes, contractors may be required to travel to IRS facilities for contract work. Contractors will be reimbursed for travel expenses related to work.
21–22	Security Requirements	Please clarify whether offerors are required to propose personnel with active Moderate MBI/background investigations at proposal submission, or whether clearances/background processing may occur after award.	Contractor personnel are not required to have a active Moderate MBI before contract award but must obtain after contract award.
21–22	Security Requirements	Please provide the estimated timeline for completion of security processing and onboarding after award.	Timing may vary based on various factors; and can range from 1-4 months.
16–19	Deliverables Schedule	Please confirm whether all recurring deliverables identified in the PWS (PMP, monthly reports, dashboards, status reports, etc.) are included within the Firm-Fixed-Price scope and should be priced within the proposed CLINs.	This will be a firm fixed price task order to include all deliverables.
2	Section I – Pricing Schedule	Please confirm whether pricing is expected at the total CLIN level only or whether supporting labor category-level pricing/cost buildup should also be submitted.	Please review Factor 3 Price starting on pg. 74 of the RFQ.
19	Section 7 – Key Personnel	Please confirm whether the Government anticipates a minimum staffing level, FTE expectation, or estimated team size for contract performance.	The Contractor will need to estimate this based on the work required by the PWS and present it in the quote.
2	Section I – Pricing Schedule / Factor 3 – Price	Please confirm whether proposed pricing under Factor 3 shall include all applicable costs, including the GSA 8(a) STARS III Contract Access Fee (CAF), or whether the CAF should be excluded and treated separately.	There will be an amendment to the RFQ to include a CAF line item.
19–20, 8–11	Section 7 – Key Personnel / Subtasks 4.2.2–4.2.4	Section 7 identifies only Project Manager, Power Apps Developer, and Power BI Developer as Key Personnel. However, Subtasks 4.2.2 through 4.2.4 reference additional personnel and specialized support areas including Power Automate support, Oracle Development/Informatica SME support, and Microsoft Power Platform SME support. Please confirm whether these additional roles are considered non-Key Personnel. Further, please clarify whether offerors are expected to propose these additional resources at the time of proposal submission and whether resumes or staffing details are required for these positions.	Follow the solicitation instructions for submission format and evaluation requirements.
25	Full-text Provisions and Clauses	The solicitation includes a "Full-text Provisions and Clauses" section containing provisions with representations and completion fields/check boxes. Please confirm whether offerors are required to complete and submit any of these provisions as part of the proposal submission package.	Quoters are expected to complete any and all applicable provisions and clauses.

72–73	Factor 2 – Relevant Past Performance	Please confirm whether subcontractor, teaming partner, or Joint Venture member past performance references may be submitted and considered as part of the Past Performance evaluation. If permitted, please clarify any limitations on the extent to which such experience may be used.	If there are contracts in which you worked with as the subcontractor, or other partnerships; this may also be submitted and is acceptable.
72–73	Factor 2 – Past Performance / CPARS	If CPARS will be evaluated, please confirm whether subcontractor, teaming partner, or Joint Venture member CPARS records may be submitted and considered as part of the evaluation process, or if only Prime Contractor CPARS records will be evaluated.	If there are contracts in which you worked with as the subcontractor, or other partnerships; this may also be submitted and is acceptable.
Page 8-9	PWS Section 4.2.2 – Workflows and Document Management (AWARE)	Can the Government clarify whether OCPO anticipates significant modernization, migration, or system transition activities during the ordering period that may impact the future role, scope, or sustainment strategy associated with AWARE and related M365 environments?	The PWS requires AWARE sustainment, updates, optimization, and support for other M365/SPO environments. Any specific modernization priorities will be coordinated with the Government Technical Lead after award.
Page 9	PWS Section 4.2.2 – AWARE Operations and Maintenance	Can the Government clarify the anticipated roadmap and priorities for AWARE sustainment versus enhancement activities during the ordering period?	The PWS requires ongoing AWARE operations, maintenance, updates, and any enhancements as requirements evolve or are made known.
Pages 8-11	PWS Sections 4.2.2–4.2.4	Can the Government clarify the current technical architecture supporting AWARE, including major integrated systems, external data sources, and dependencies across Power Platform, SharePoint Online, Oracle, SAP/PPS, and reporting environments?	The PWS identifies AWARE as built on SPO using Power Apps, Power Automate, and Power BI, with SharePoint document storage and integrations. Other applications and systems have integrations with the M365 environments.
Pages 8-11	PWS Sections 4.2.2–4.2.4	Can the Government clarify whether contractor personnel will be provided administrative access to AWARE, SharePoint Online, Power BI workspaces, Oracle environments, and associated reporting/data environments necessary to perform required support activities?	Contractors required to use these systems to perform contract work will have administrative or ability to access these systems.
Pages 8-11	PWS Sections 4.2.2–4.2.4	Can the Government clarify the approximate operational volume associated with the environment, including active AWARE users, average monthly support tickets, enhancement requests, dashboards/reports maintained, and SharePoint sites or libraries supported?	The PWS/QASP do not provide historical volume counts. Offerors should propose staffing and processes sufficient to meet the stated ticket, deliverable, and service-level requirements.
Pages 8-11	PWS Sections 4.2.2–4.2.4	Can the Government clarify whether the contractor will support both operational sustainment activities and enhancement/development activities, or whether certain development activities are managed separately by Government personnel or other contractors?	The PWS requires both operational sustainment and development/enhancement activities, support, and maintenance working alongside Government personnel.
N/A	Operational Environment	Can the Government clarify whether there are any current operational pain points, reporting challenges, workflow bottlenecks, data quality concerns, or integration limitations the Government would like offerors to specifically address in their quotations?	The PWS identifies required support areas and outcomes but does not provide additional pain-point data. Offerors should address workflow, reporting, data, and governance risks within the stated PWS scope.
Pages 11-12	PWS Section 4.2.5 – OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Can the Government clarify whether examples involving acquisition analytics, procurement governance, workflow optimization, and executive decision-support reporting are considered highly relevant to Subtask 2.5, Visualization & Data Analysis?	Yes. Examples involving acquisition analytics, procurement workflow optimization, governance, and executive decision-support reporting are relevant to PWS Subtask 4.2.5.
Pages 8-12	PWS Sections 4.2.1–4.2.5	Can the Government clarify whether the contractor will be expected to facilitate governance forums, working groups, or executive review sessions related to procurement operations, workflows, reporting, analytics, or system modernization?	The PWS requires participation in review meetings, governance support, dashboard reviews, weekly data analysis, and monthly reporting. Specific meeting cadence will be set by the Government.

Pages 8-12	PWS Sections 4.2.1–4.2.5	Can the Government clarify whether workflow/process optimization recommendations and continuous improvement activities are expected as part of ongoing operational support services?	Yes. The Contractor shall provide full support for the ongoing operations and maintenance, updates, and any optimization of supported solutions. Continuous improvement is required for data analysis listed in the PWS in 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis.
Pages 11-12	PWS Section 4.2.5 – OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Can the Government clarify whether contractor personnel will be expected to support procurement performance analysis, workload balancing analysis, forecasting, or procurement trend/risk analysis as part of dashboarding and analytics support?	Yes, please refer to the PWS.
Pages 11-12	PWS Section 4.2.5 – Dashboards and Reporting	Can the Government clarify the approximate number and complexity of existing Power BI dashboards and automated reporting processes currently maintained within the OCPO environment?	The PWS lists current dashboard areas but does not provide the number or complexity of dashboards. Offerors should propose an approach capable of maintaining and enhancing any identified dashboards/reports.
Pages 8-11	PWS Sections 4.2.2–4.2.4	Can the Government clarify whether the environment currently includes custom-developed connectors, automations, scripts, macros, workflows, or integrations requiring ongoing sustainment support?	The PWS identifies workflows , tasks, applications, and process areas for support. These will include custom solutions and activities requiring ongoing sustainment support as within the scope of this PWS.
Pages 8-11	PWS Sections 4.2.2–4.2.4	Can the Government clarify whether development, testing, staging, and production environments currently exist for AWARE and associated reporting/data environments, and whether contractors will support deployment coordination between environments?	There are testing, implementation support, and coordination with production ennvironments. Specific environment details will be provided after award.
Pages 8-12	PWS Sections 4.2.1–4.2.5	Can the Government clarify whether formal configuration management, release management, or change management processes currently govern workflow, dashboard, and reporting updates?	Formal configuration, release, and change management processes do govern. Spefic details may change depending on the nature of some of the process and solutions.
Pages 8-12	PWS Sections 4.2.1–4.2.5 and Section 11.0 Security Requirements	Can the Government clarify whether the contractor will support cybersecurity compliance, records retention, CUI governance, audit support, or other governance/compliance activities beyond those specifically identified in the PWS?	The contractor may support IT compliance and governance programs as they pertain to technologies and solutions supported and maintained by the contractor.
Page 7 and QASP Pages 7-8	PWS Section 4.3 – Transition Out	Can the Government clarify whether incumbent contractor personnel are expected to support transition activities and knowledge transfer efforts during transition-in?	Yes, this is required and listed in the PWS of the contract.
Page 2 and QASP Page 1	RFQ Staffing Requirements / QASP Section 2.0	Can the Government clarify whether key personnel are required, or whether offerors may propose flexible staffing models aligned to operational workload demands and evolving modernization priorities?	Key Personnel is discussed in the PWS section 7.0.
N/A	Operational Planning	Can the Government clarify whether significant fluctuations in workload volume are anticipated during the ordering period due to procurement surges, organizational changes, modernization activities, or system transition initiatives?	The PWS/QASP do not identify anticipated workload surges. Offerors should propose a staffing approach capable of meeting all stated deliverables, SLAs, and performance standards throughout the POP.
Pages 4-7 and QASP Pages 3-7	Contract Status Reporting / QASP Reporting Requirements	Can the Government clarify whether recurring executive-level reporting deliverables, operational reviews, or dashboard briefings currently exist under the incumbent effort beyond those specifically identified in the PWS/QASP?	Recurring reporting deliverables are identified in the PWS/QASP, including review meetings, monthly status reports, dashboard reviews, weekly data analysis, and monthly dashboard progress reports. Frequencies may change for topics based on internal needs and requirements over time.
Pages 9-12	PWS Sections 4.2.2–4.2.5	Can the Government clarify whether there are any preferred certifications, technical standards, governance frameworks, or platform administration standards applicable to Power Platform, SharePoint Online, Oracle, Informatica, Power BI, or M365 administration under this effort?	The PWS identifies required experience and technical skill sets. No additional preferred certifications are specified.

Pages 7–14	Section II – PWS, Section 4.2 Technical Support Services,	The PWS identifies support responsibilities across governance, AWARE workflow support, SharePoint administration, Oracle data warehouse support, Informatica workflows, dashboard development, analytics, CRS ticket support, training, and executive reporting. Can the Government provide historical monthly averages for CRS support requests, AWARE enhancement requests, SharePoint support requests, dashboard/reporting requests, and data warehouse support activities to assist Offerors in developing realistic staffing and workload management approaches?	The PWS/QASP do not provide historical workload averages. Offerors should develop staffing based on the stated scope, outcomes, ticket response times, deliverables, and performance standards.
Pages 8–13	Section II – PWS, Sections 4.2.2 through 4.2.5	Can the Government provide the approximate number of active SharePoint Online sites, Power Platform applications, production dashboards/reports, active AWARE workflows, Oracle database integrations, and supported OCPO users currently maintained under this effort?	The PWS identifies the systems and support areas but does not provide counts of sites, apps, dashboards, workflows, integrations, or users. Offerors should propose based on the PWS scope.
Page 8	Section II – PWS, Section 4.2.2 AWARE	The solicitation establishes aggressive response and ticket claim timelines for AWARE support. Can the Government provide the historical average daily and monthly ticket volume, percentage of urgent versus standard tickets, and average number of enhancement requests received monthly to support accurate staffing and SLA planning?	The PWS/QASP do not provide historical workload averages. Offerors should develop staffing based on the stated scope, outcomes, ticket response times, deliverables, and performance standards.
Pages 10–11	Section II – PWS, Section 4.2.4 SharePoint	Can the Government clarify the current operational scope of the SharePoint environment, including the number of active sites, site collections, workflows/forms maintained, approximate storage footprint, and average monthly CRS service requests?	The PWS identifies the systems and support areas but does not provide counts of sites, apps, dashboards, workflows, integrations, or users. Offerors should propose based on the PWS scope.
Pages 9–10	Section II – PWS, Section 4.2.3 Data Warehouse	Can the Government clarify the approximate number of active ETL workflows, frequency of Oracle and Informatica support activities, number of external data feeds/interfaces, and whether Oracle PL/SQL and Informatica support are recurring operational requirements or periodic advisory/support activities?	The PWS identifies Oracle, Informatica, Oracle Data Connector, ODBC, and external/internal source systems, but does not provide quantities or version details. Offerors should propose based on stated PWS outcomes.
Pages 11–14	Section II – PWS, Section 4.2.5 Visualization & Data Analysis	Can the Government clarify the approximate number of dashboards currently maintained, average monthly volume of dashboard modification requests, frequency of ad hoc executive reporting requests, and expected level of predictive analytics and forecasting support anticipated during the POP?	The PWS lists current dashboard/reporting areas but does not provide dashboard counts or request volumes. Offerors should support all listed dashboards and the forecasting/analytics outcomes in Subtask 4.2.5.
Page 13	Section II – PWS, Section 4.2.5 Visualization & Data Analysis	The PWS references support for datasets exceeding 100,000 rows and enterprise-level analytics. Can the Government clarify anticipated data volumes, expected refresh frequencies, current reporting architecture, and whether existing data models and dashboards will be provided to the successful contractor?	The PWS states dashboards may involve more than 100,000 rows and requires daily refresh/system availability. Existing data models and artifacts will be coordinated with the contractor after award as applicable.
Pages 19–20	Section II – PWS, Section 7.0 Key Personnel	The solicitation identifies three primary labor categories/key roles. Can the Government clarify whether Offerors may propose cross-functional personnel supporting multiple technical disciplines simultaneously, provided all required service levels and deliverables are achieved?	Yes, offerors can. This requirement is a PWS and government does not propose the labor mix and suggested in order to address the PWS.
Pages 7–20	Section II – PWS, Sections 4.2 and 7.0	Can the Government clarify whether all functional disciplines identified within the PWS are expected to require continuous active support throughout the period of performance, or whether certain areas (e.g., Oracle/Informatica support, forecasting analytics, executive dashboarding) are anticipated to be intermittent or surge-based activities?	All PWS task areas must be supported throughout the period of performance as needed to meet deliverables and service levels. The Government does not prescribe the labor mix or level of effort by discipline.
Pages 6–7 and QASP Pages 2–6	Section II – PWS, Section 4.1.3 and QASP PRS Metrics, Pages 6–7 and QASP Pages 2–6	Can the Government clarify whether performance evaluation will primarily focus on successful achievement of service levels and deliverable timelines, or whether evaluation of staffing levels and labor allocation will also be considered as part of technical acceptability/performance assessment?	The Technical Approach and Performance will be evaluated against the PWS outcomes.

Pages 14–20	Section II – PWS, Section 8.0 Period of Performance and Section 4.3 Transition Out	Can the Government clarify whether transition-in activities are expected immediately upon award or whether a phase-in overlap period with the incumbent contractor is anticipated?	Transition-in activities will start immediately at the time of award.
Pages 8-9	PWS 4.2.2 – AWARE Support	The PWS states that "Enhancement/Policy requests shall be implemented no later than three days after receiving the request from the Government Technical Lead." Please clarify whether this requirement applies to all enhancement requests regardless of complexity, and whether the Government intends to establish a prioritization, approval, or sizing process for larger development efforts.	The PWS requires ongoing AWARE operations, maintenance, updates, optimization, and enhancement/policy requests implemented within three days after Government Technical Lead request. Considerations will be made for any larger development efforts as determined for specific requests.
9	PWS 4.2.2 – AWARE Support Ticket Metrics	The solicitation references both an "average ticket claim time under 10 minutes" and later "tickets no longer than seven minutes (Regular Tickets) and five minutes (Urgent Tickets)." Please clarify which metric governs contractor performance acceptance.	The PWS outcome requires AWARE tickets to be claimed within 7 minutes for regular tickets and 5 minutes for urgent tickets, with median support time not exceeding 30 minutes.
10	PWS 4.2.3 – Data Warehouse	Please clarify whether the Government will provide existing architecture diagrams, ETL workflow documentation, Oracle schema/data dictionary documentation, and Informatica mappings during transition-in.	The PWS requires transition/turnover support and transfer of artifacts, documentation, and deliverables. Available architecture, workflow, schema, and mapping documentation will be provided after award as applicable.
10	PWS 4.2.3 – Data Warehouse Support	The PWS references Oracle development, PL/SQL support, Informatica workflows, Oracle Data Connector support, Power BI, and SharePoint integrations. Please clarify whether all required software licenses, environments, and infrastructure access will be Government furnished.	Yes, will be furnished by the Government.
11	PWS 4.2.4 – SharePoint Support	The PWS requires CRS service requests to be resolved within two business days unless identified as an extended task or project. Please clarify the process and criteria for categorizing requests as "extended tasks or projects."	The PWS requires initial CRS response within one business day and resolution within two business days from assignment unless the Government Technical Lead identifies the work as an extended task or project.
13	PWS 4.2.5 – Dashboard Development	The solicitation states that draft dashboards shall be developed within five days of request, updated within two days of Government feedback, and finalized within two days of additional Government feedback. Please clarify whether these timelines apply to all dashboard requests regardless of scope, complexity, integrations, or data availability.	The PWS requires draft dashboards within five days of request, updates within two days of Government feedback, and finalization within two days of feedback. Certain scope and complexity may apply and will be considered on a case by case basis.
19-20	Section 7 – Key Personnel	The solicitation identifies only three key personnel roles (Project Manager, Power Apps Developer, and Power BI Developer), while the PWS includes requirements for Oracle development, Informatica support, SharePoint administration, Power Platform support, help desk operations, dashboarding, and data analysis. Please clarify whether the Government anticipates additional non-key personnel roles beyond those identified in Section 7.	The Government will not dictate the number of non-key personnel. This requirement has a PWS, and the labor mix proposed should be able to perform the requirements in the PWS.
	Section 4.2	Can the Government please provide the following? number of SharePoint sites volume of AWARE transactions, size/structure of the data warehouse and any other relevant volumetric information?	The PWS/QASP do not provide volumetric counts. Offerors should propose based on the PWS scope for SharePoint, AWARE, the data warehouse, dashboards, and related support services.
	Section 4.2.2	On AWARE (4.2.2), the body of the PWS states tickets should be claimed within an average of 10 minutes, but the Outcome section then states 7 minutes for regular tickets and 5 minutes for urgent tickets. Can the Government please help reconcile these timings?	The PWS outcome provides the controlling detailed ticket metrics: regular tickets claimed within 7 minutes, urgent tickets within 5 minutes, and median support time not exceeding 30 minutes.
20	PWS 9.0 Place of Performance	How much time is historically required of key personnel to be on client site (vs contractor/remote site) for mission success and proper coordination?	The PWS identifies the primary place of performance as remote, with possible access to IRS facilities. It does not establish a historical or minimum onsite presence requirement.

8	4.2.2 Sub Task 2.2	Please clarify whether the Government anticipates:	Offerors should base their responses on the PWS/QASP scope, deliverables, outcomes, and performance standards. Additional operational details will be coordinated with the successful contractor after award, as applicable.
		o Major functional enhancements and redesign of existing AWARE workflows (redesign of workflows, major power platform enhancements, cloud migration, ETL modernization Architectural transformation), or	The PWS requires ongoing AWARE operations, maintenance, updates, optimization, and enhancements. Anything minor or major will be determined as needs or requirements arise.
		o Primarily sustainment, optimization, and incremental improvements to existing AWARE capabilities.	The PWS requires ongoing AWARE operations, maintenance, updates, optimization, and enhancements. Anything minor or major will be determined as needs or requirements arise.
9	4.2.3 Sub Task 2.3	Does the Government anticipate any near term technology modernization (e.g., migration to cloud native data platforms, introduction of new ETL tools, or data virtualization), or should offerors assume minimal platform enhancement and optimization of the current Oracle environment?	The PWS requires maintenance of the current Oracle/Informatica data warehouse environment and related optimization/support.
10	4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4	Can the Government provide additional clarity on:	
		o The current scale of the OCPO SharePoint environment (e.g., approximate number of site collections, users, and primary M365 workloads in scope), and	The PWS/QASP do not provide volumetric counts. Offerors should propose based on the PWS scope for SharePoint, AWARE, the data warehouse, dashboards, and related support services.
		o Whether the contractor will be responsible for coordinating with any enterprise IRS M365/SharePoint governance bodies outside of OCPO, or only for OCPO specific governance and solutions.	The PWS requires compliance with IRS SharePoint policy guidance and governance. Coordination with enterprise governance bodies will occur as directed by the Government.
11	4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5	Please confirm:	Offerors should base their responses on the PWS/QASP scope, deliverables, outcomes, and performance standards. Additional operational details will be coordinated with the successful contractor after award, as applicable.
		o Whether Microsoft Power BI is the Government's primary visualization platform for OCPO analytics; and	The PWS identifies Power BI as a primary dashboarding/reporting tool, along with any Excel, SharePoint, Power Apps, and other programs depending on the intended audience.
		o Whether any additional analytics/visualization tools (e.g., Tableau, Qlik, Excel based solutions) are currently in use or are expected to be supported under this task.	The PWS emphasizes Power BI, Excel, SharePoint, Power Apps, and other programs depending on the intended audience. No additional named visualization tools are specified.
	2.0 Technical Acceptance Criteria and basis for the award Factor (1) and (2)	Please clarify whether the Government prefers:	
		o A single integrated Technical Volume where relevant past performance is embedded within the technical narrative, or	

		o A Technical Volume that contains clearly separated subsections for (1) Technical Approach and (2) Relevant Past Performance project summaries.	Yes, a Technical Volume that contains clearly separated subsections for (1) Technical Approach and (2) Relevant Past Performance project summaries.
	3.0 Basis for Award D.	Please clarify whether “Low Confidence” may be assigned to Price or is limited to non price factors only.	Price will be evaluated, but will not be assigned an adjectival rating.
	3.0 Basis for Award K.	Please confirm whether the Government will exclude any pricing associated with 52.217 8 from the total evaluated price (TEP) for purposes of evaluation, and whether offerors should still provide explicit rates or pricing assumptions for potential 52.217 8 extensions.	The Price for the effort associated with FAR 52.217-8 Option to Extend Services will not be included in the total awarded value. If, at the end of the period of performance and within the time period established in the clause, the Government chooses to exercise the option, the pricing will be pursuant to the rates specified in the contract.
Pg. 1	QASP §Objective	Is the OCPO Microsoft 365 and SharePoint Online environment fully migrated to the IRS enterprise cloud, or does the scope of work include the migration, refactoring, or consolidation of legacy on-premises SharePoint farms or shared drives into the M365 tenant?	The existing IRS M365 and SharePoint environments are on the enterprise cloud.
Pg. 1; Page 10, Surveillance Matrix	RFQ; QASP	Will the contractor be expected to maintain, configure, or engineer underlying DevSecOps pipelines, automated deployment scripts, or code repositories for OCPO M365 applications, or is the technical support limited strictly to low-code/no-code configuration, native SPO administration, and Power Platform development?	The PWS scope is focused on M365/SPO, Power Platform, data warehouse, workflow, and reporting support. It does not separately require DevSecOps pipeline engineering.
Pg. 10, Surveillance Matrix (Bottom Row)	QASP	Will the Government provide the contractor with direct administrative access to the underlying M365 Unified Audit Log (UAL) and Azure Active Directory/Entra ID reporting APIs to programmatically extract governance data, or will the contractor rely on manually exported reports provided by the IRS Central IT enterprise administration team?	The PWS states the Contractor will access IRS systems, reports, and data only as needed for the task order. Specific audit-log/API access will be coordinated after award as required.
Pg. 10, Surveillance Matrix (Middle Rows)	QASP	Given the rapid turnarounds required for dashboards and application updates in the QASP, does the Government require a formalized Agile sprint management framework with structured sprint planning and review cycles, or will taskings be managed via an operational ticket/queue-based system (e.g., Kanban or Tier 3 O&M support)?	Currently the work uses a specific Agile framework. It requires review meetings, status reporting, documentation, testing, and timely delivery under the PWS/QASP service levels.
Pg. 1	QASP §Objective	Are the M365 applications and SharePoint environments within the scope of this task order subject to IRS Publication 1075 (Tax Information Security Guidelines) or specific FISMA "High" overlay controls? If so, will the contractor be responsible for authoring or updating SSPs or supporting the A&A process for these applications?	The PWS requires compliance with Publication 4812 and IRM, including IRM 10.8. It does not expressly require SSP authoring or A&A support unless directed within the contract scope.
Pg. 1 (Description of Services); Pg. 1 (Objective - M365/SharePoint Online Environment & Data Management)	RFQ; QASP	Can the Government provide the approximate size, structure, and current health of the existing OCPO SharePoint Online (SPO) environment (e.g., number of active site collections, custom applications, custom workflows, Power Platform integrations, and total data volume)? Furthermore, are there any known legacy technical debts, broken permissions structures, or outdated workflows (e.g., SharePoint 2013/2016 workflows) that require immediate remediation upon award?	The PWS identifies the SPO/M365 environment and support scope but does not provide size, health, or technical debt details. Offerors should propose based on stated PWS requirements.

Pg. 10; §4.2.5	QASP; PWS	The QASP indicates that draft dashboards must be developed within five (5) days of request and finalized within two (2) days of Government feedback. To ensure realistic pricing and scoping, will the Government provide pre-cleared, structured, and normalized data sources for these requests, or does the scope include extensive data extraction, cleaning, and ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) engineering from disparate IRS transactional systems?	The PWS includes data extraction, joins/connections, data tables, dashboard development, and analytics. Offerors should propose an approach that accounts for required data preparation and validation as data may be from different sources.
Page 74	RFQ	Page 74 of the RFQ states, "The Offeror shall submit pricing information supported by a breakdown of the labor categories, hourly rates, estimated hours, estimated other direct costs, and travel estimates to be considered responsive/eligible for contract award." As no pricing template was provided, please confirm offerors can submit their own pricing format as long as it meets the above requirements.	Quoters can submit their own format as long as it meets stated requirements.
	Attachment 1 Initial Staffing Plan	Attachment 1, Initial Staffing Plan, is identified as a Proposal Deliverable and includes fields for "Employee Last Name" and "Employee First Name." However, the same table also states that the PIV/Employee Unique ID "must provide NLT first Monthly Report," which suggests some employee-specific information may be permitted after award. Please confirm whether offerors are required to identify proposed employee names in the Initial Staffing Plan at quote submission, or whether offerors may provide labor categories, labor type, employer company, and estimated LOE only, with employee names to be provided after award or no later than the first Monthly Workforce Report.	PIV Employee Unique ID can be provided later. All other information must be provided with the quote submission.
Page 74	RFQ Factor 3 Price	The PWS requires the Contractor to provide ongoing support across AWARE, SharePoint/M365, Power Platform, Power BI dashboards, data warehouse/ETL, governance, training, help desk support, reporting, and project management. However, the RFQ does not appear to provide historical workload metrics, such as average monthly ticket volume, number of AWARE users, number of SharePoint sites supported, number of dashboards/reports in production, number of monthly enhancement requests, number of ETL workflows, data warehouse objects, training sessions, or average ad hoc data/reporting requests.	The PWS/QASP do not provide historical workload metrics. Offerors should price and staff based on the stated PWS scope, deliverables, service levels, and performance standards.
		To enable all offerors to develop a realistic, credible, and competitively comparable staffing solution, will the Government provide historical workload metrics for each major task area?	The PWS/QASP do not provide historical workload metrics. Offerors should base staffing on the major task areas, stated outcomes, and required service levels.
10	PWS Section 4.2.3 Data Warehouse	The PWS requires ≥99% system availability for the data warehouse environment. Please clarify whether the Contractor will be responsible for system availability of Government-owned infrastructure or only for Contractor-performed maintenance, monitoring, and support activities within its control.	The PWS requires the Contractor to maintain OCPO's data warehouse and meet the stated availability/ETL outcomes for activities within contract scope, while coordinating with IT and Government owned infrastructure for permissions and up time.
11–13	PWS Section 4.2.5 OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	The PWS requires ≥99% data accuracy and integrity and daily data refresh/system availability. Please clarify how the Government will measure data accuracy and what systems or data sources are included in the daily refresh requirement.	The PWS/QASP require 99% data accuracy/integrity and daily data refresh/system availability for dashboards. Validation will be based on Government requirements, source data, and accepted deliverables.
8-9	PWS Section 4.2.2 AWARE	Please confirm whether the Government currently uses a formal ticketing platform for AWARE support tracking and reporting. If so, identify the platform and required reporting metrics.	The PWS identifies AWARE help desk support and ticket claim/support-time metrics, but does not name a specific ticketing platform.

8-9	PWS Section 4.2.2 AWARE	Please confirm whether the Government maintains a separate development, test, and production environments for AWARE and Power Platform solutions.	Yes
8-9	PWS Section 4.2.2 AWARE	Please clarify expected after hours or emergency support requirements for severe AWARE outages or production impacting incidents.	AWARE issues must be escalated to the Government Task Lead within 1-2 hours with a recommended resolution.
10-11	PWS Section 4.2.2 AWARE	Please clarify whether the Government maintains an existing SharePoint governance framework, taxonomy standard, or records retention schedule that the Contractor must follow.	The PWS requires governance to incorporate IRS policies and procedures, records retention, and CUI standards. Specific existing frameworks/taxonomies will be provided after award as applicable.
10-11, 17	PWS Section 4.2.4 SharePoint; Deliverables Schedule	Please confirm whether CRS service requests are managed through an existing Government-provided platform and whether reporting dashboards currently exist for CRS metrics.	The PWS requires initial CRS response within one business day and resolution within two business days from assignment unless the Government Technical Lead identifies the work as an extended task or project. Data and information are availabel internally and can be provided after award.
9-10	PWS Section 4.2.3 Data Warehouse	Please confirm the current Oracle database version, Informatica version, & primary ETL tools used within the OCPO data warehouse environment.	The PWS identifies Oracle, Informatica, Oracle Data Connector, and ODBC as primary technologies, but does not provide version information.
7	PWS Section 4.2.1	Please describe the current scope of the data governance environment under Task 4.2.1, including the number of governance documents, workflows, and reporting tools requiring monthly updates, and whether a CUI inventory and records retention schedule are already in place.	The PWS requires governance support for SharePoint workflow trackers, dashboards, reports, policy, records retention, and CUI, but does not provide counts of governance artifacts.
10	PWS Section 4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4 - SharePoint	What is the estimated internal and external user population supported?	The PWS requires maintenance of OCPO SharePoint, applications and solutions. User population and activities will vary.
10	PWS Section 4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4 - SharePoint	Are Model-Driven Apps currently utilized within the OCPO Power Platform environment?	Yes
10	PWS Section 4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4 - SharePoint	Beyond SharePoint Online and Dataverse, are there additional enterprise or external data sources currently leveraged by Power Apps, Power Automate, or Power BI solutions (e.g., Oracle, SAP PPS, SQL Server, APIs, Excel, Azure services)?	Yes
10	PWS Section 4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4 - SharePoint	In reference to Sub Task 2.4 performance monitoring requirements, what monitoring, logging, and performance management tools are currently available within the IRS infrastructure for SharePoint Online, Power Platform, and associated applications?	Various methods will be used to monitor performance such as user logs, reports, activity histories, or user engagements.
8	PWS Section 4.2.2 Sub Task 2.2	Is AWARE currently fully operational within the production environment? Please provide the approximate number of active users and peak concurrent users supported by the platform.	The PWS identifies AWARE as an operational tool requiring ongoing support, but does not provide user counts or peak concurrent users

8	PWS Section 4.2.2 Sub Task 2.2	What are the primary operational, performance, scalability, or usability challenges currently experienced within the AWARE environment?	The PWS does not identify specific or current AWARE pain points. Offerors should address operations, maintenance, updates, optimization, training, and help desk support.
8	PWS Section 4.2.2 Sub Task 2.2	What ticketing or IT Service Management (ITSM) platform is currently utilized to support AWARE help desk operations (e.g., ServiceNow, Jira, Remedy)?	The PWS identifies AWARE help desk support and ticket claim/support-time metrics, but does not name a specific ticketing platform.
8	PWS Section 4.2.2 Sub Task 2.2	Can the Government provide average monthly ticket volumes for AWARE support, including breakdowns for standard versus urgent tickets?	The PWS/QASP do not provide AWARE monthly ticket volumes. Offerors should staff to meet the stated ticket claim and support-time requirements.
8	PWS Section 4.2.2 Sub Task 2.2	What are the most common or recurring AWARE support issues currently encountered by users?	The PWS does not identify recurring AWARE issues. Offerors should propose support for document management, workflows, training, help desk, enhancements, and any severe issue resolution.
9	PWS Section 4.2.3 Sub Task 2.3 - Data Warehouse	For Sub Task 2.3 (Data Warehouse), Are there any existing API's connectig to data ware house? what is the current approximate size of the Oracle data warehouse environment, and what annual data growth rate should the Contractor anticipate?	The PWS identifies Oracle, Oracle Data Connector, ODBC, Informatica, and external/internal source systems but does not provide warehouse size, API counts, or growth rates.
9	PWS Section 4.2.3 Sub Task 2.3 - Data Warehouse	Approximately how many ETL workflows and Informatica jobs are currently maintained within the environment?	The PWS requires ETL/Informatica workflow maintenance but does not provide the number of workflows or jobs.
9	PWS Section 4.2.3 Sub Task 2.3 - Data Warehouse	Can we assume data ware house system is managed and supported by internal data warehouse team.	No. The PWS states the Contractor shall maintain OCPO's data warehouse and coordinate with IT and Government for required permissions and production deployment/fixes.
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Are there any known data quality, reconciliation, or data consistency issues within the current warehouse environment?	No
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Regarding Sub Task 2.5 (Visualization & Data Analysis), are enterprise dashboards currently centralized and managed within the Power BI Service? Approximately how many operational dashboards and reports are currently maintained?	The PWS identifies Power BI as a primary dashboard/reporting tool and lists multiple current dashboard areas, but does not provide counts of reports or dashboards. The contractor and OCPO will manage OCPO owned dashboards.
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	What reporting gaps, visualization limitations, or analytics challenges are currently identified by OCPO leadership and stakeholders?	The PWS identifies desired analytics outcomes, including transparency, workload management, procurement decision-making, forecasting, and risk identification. It does not provide additional gap details.
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Are there existing concerns related to dashboard data latency, refresh performance, or timeliness of reporting data?	The PWS requires daily data refresh and system availability but does not identify existing latency or refresh performance concerns.
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Have there been any known Power BI performance challenges associated with large datasets, complex models, or high user concurrency?	No
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	What tools, processes, or standards are currently used by developers to validate Section 508 compliance for SharePoint, Power BI, and Power Platform deliverables?	Existing tools used by agency are 508 compliant, or can be submitted through our internal 508 Office for compliance reviews and assessment.

11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Are there on-premises or hybrid data sources that future dashboards or reports will need to integrate with? If so, are existing on-premises data gateways already established and available for contractor use?	The PWS identifies internal and external data sources and the Oracle data warehouse. Potentially, if new data sources need to be accessed and can be coordinated at that time.
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Are dashboards expected to provide near real-time/live data, or are scheduled refresh intervals acceptable? If scheduled refreshes are acceptable, what are the expected refresh frequencies?	The PWS requires daily data refresh and system availability for dashboarding/analytics capabilities. Specific refresh schedules will be coordinated with the Government Lead.
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Are Power BI Paginated Reports currently in use, or are there anticipated future requirements for paginated reporting capabilities?	The PWS requires dashboards, reports, and data-related work products but does not specifically identify Power BI Paginated Reports.
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Beyond AWARE support, is there an enterprise-wide ITSM platform currently utilized for operational support and service request management across OCPO systems and applications?	No
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	Which current manual business processes consume the greatest amount of operational effort and may present the highest opportunity for workflow automation or process optimization?	The PWS identifies automation, workflow optimization, dashboarding, and reporting support areas but does not specify which manual processes have the highest optimization priority.
11	PWS Section 4.2.5 Sub Task 2.5 - OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis	What are the Government's primary pain points, operational challenges, or areas of concern within the current OCPO technical environment?	The PWS identifies support needs and desired outcomes but does not provide additional current pain points.
10	PWS Section 4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4 - SharePoint	Which service level metrics, operational KPIs, or performance outcomes are considered most critical for successful contractor performance under this effort?	The PWS identifies support needs and desired outcomes.
10	PWS Section 4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4 - SharePoint	Regarding application lifecycle management and deployment processes for AWARE, SharePoint, and Power Platform solutions, how are deployments currently managed across development, test, UAT, and production environments? Additionally, are there existing CI/CD pipelines, Azure DevOps pipelines, or automated deployment processes currently established for solution deployments and releases?	The PWS requires testing, documentation, and coordination with IT and Government Task Leads for production deployment. It does not identify existing CI/CD or Azure DevOps pipeline details.
10	PWS Section 4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4 - SharePoint	Are there any dedictaed service accounts for managing powerplatform solutions & what level of permissions does contractor have on evniornments to perfome there duties	Some are available.
10	PWS Section 4.2.4 Sub Task 2.4 - SharePoint	Are there any design, architecture documents for existing implementaion	Yes, and can be made available upon award.
14	PWS Section 4.3 Task 3 - Transition Out	Please identify the incumbent contractor currently performing the work described under this requirement.	Anika Systems Inc.
14	PWS Section 4.3 Task 3 - Transition Out	Please provide the current dollar value of the incumbent contract, including the base period, all exercised option periods, modifications, and task orders, as applicable.	Contract 2032H8-25-C-00017 was awarded for $2,361,302.40.
14	PWS Section 4.3 Task 3 - Transition Out	Will the Government provide incumbent staffing information necessary to support transition planning, including current labor categories, staffing levels, key personnel roles, work locations, and clearance or credentialing requirements?	Offerors should propose a staffing approach sufficient to meet PWS and QASP requirements. Incubment staffing information can be made available to the successful offeror.

0	General	Can the government provide the estimated number of LCATS?	No. The Government does not dictate the labor mix for this PWS requirement.
9	PWS Section 4.2.3, Subtask 2.3 – Data Warehouse	PWS Section 4.2.3, Subtask 2.3 – Data Warehouse includes responsibilities related to managing ETL workflows and supporting data warehouse activities. However, the PWS appears to identify only Power Platform and Power BI resource roles, and does not appear to include a dedicated Data Warehouse, ETL Developer, Data Engineer, or similar labor category. Since ETL workflow management typically requires specialized data engineering and data warehouse expertise beyond the standard Power Platform/Power BI developer skillset, will the Government clarify whether a separate Data Warehouse/ETL resource is required, or whether these responsibilities are expected to be performed by the identified Power Platform and Power BI resources?	The PWS identifies required data warehouse/ETL responsibilities but does not prescribe labor categories beyond the Key Personnel roles. Offerors should propose any additional resources needed to meet the PWS.
Page: 19-20	Solicitation Reference: PWS Section 7.0 (Key Personnel)	Does the Government require Letters of Commitment from proposed Key Personnel who are not currently employed by the offeror at the time of quote submission? If letters of commitment are required, should they be included within the Technical Volume or submitted as a separate attachment outside of the page limit?	The PWS does not require Letters of Commitment. Follow the solicitation instructions for any required personnel documentation or include these with the resumes.
73	Initial Staffing Plan	Please confirm whether offerors may propose contingent hires for labor categories that are not currently staffed at the time of quote submission.	The PWS requires the contractor to submit a written staffing plan before performance and notify the Government of staffing changes. Offerors should follow RFQ instructions for proposed personnel at quote submission.
4.2.2	AWARE Support Hours	Please confirm whether AWARE help desk support is required only during 8:00 AM–5:30 PM ET on Federal business days, or whether after-hours, weekend, or emergency support is expected.	The PWS states AWARE help desk support is during business hours, 8:00 AM-5:30 PM ET. AWARE issues must be escalated to the Government Task Lead within 1-2 hours with a recommended resolution. Surge support will be discussed as needed after award.
4.2.2	AWARE / PPS Integration	Please confirm whether integration with Procurement for Public Sector/SAP PPS is an existing integration, planned enhancement, or future requirement to be supported under this task order.	Specific status will be coordinated after award.
23–54	Section III – Solicitation Provisions and Clauses	Several provisions within Section III require Offeror-completed representations and certifications, including FAR 52.209-11 (tax liability/felony conviction representation), the Information System and Security Control Standards applicability checkboxes (IRM 10.8.1 / Publication 4812 / SOFT / NET selection), and the IPP Contractor Point of Contact information. Can the Government confirm: (1) whether these completed representations must be submitted with the quote, and (2) if so, in which volume should they be included (e.g., Price Volume, as a standalone volume, or as an attachment)?	This can be completed as part of the Price Volume.
10–15	Section II, PWS §4.2 – AWARE Support Requirements	PWS §4.2 references ongoing support, enhancements, and modernization activities within the AWARE platform. Can the Government clarify the anticipated balance between steady-state operational support versus enhancement and capability expansion efforts over the period of performance?	The PWS requires both steady-state AWARE support and enhancements/optimization. Offerors should plan for operations, maintenance, training, help desk, updates, and process/system efficiencies.
14–22	Section II, PWS §4.2.4 – Security & Operational Requirements	To support alignment with existing enterprise governance and operational practices, can the Government provide additional insight into the governance and administrative controls currently applicable to contractor-supported Power Platform solutions, including deployment oversight, environment management, and data protection expectations?	The PWS requires compliance with IRS SharePoint policy guidance, governance, security policies, data integrity, and IRS infrastructure controls. Specific controls will be coordinated after award.

20	Section II, PWS – Power Apps Developer Requirements	PWS §4.2.3 identifies Oracle as a central enterprise data source supporting SharePoint and Power Platform integrations. Can the Government clarify whether the current application landscape primarily leverages enterprise data integrations, Microsoft Dataverse, or a hybrid architecture across supported Power Platform solutions?	The PWS indicates a hybrid application landscape involving SharePoint Online, Power Platform/Dataverse, Oracle data warehouse connections, and other internal/external data sources.
13–15	Section II, PWS §4.2.3 – Data Warehouse / ETL Support	PWS §4.2.3 references Oracle and Informatica-based integration workflows. Can the Government provide any relevant enterprise platform standardization considerations or technology lifecycle constraints that may impact transition planning and ongoing support activities?	The PWS identifies current Oracle/Informatica and M365/Power Platform technologies but does not provide additional lifecycle or standardization constraints. Offerors should plan for the stated environment, with potential for further optimization after award or as landscape evolves.
13–15	Section II, PWS §4.2.3 – Data Integration Requirements	PWS §4.2.3 references multiple enterprise integration pathways supporting OCPO operations. Can the Government provide additional context regarding the operational integration landscape and any enterprise integration governance considerations applicable to external systems such as FPDS, SAM.gov, and PPS/SAP?	The PWS identifies PPS/SAP, FPDS, SAM.gov, USAspending, SharePoint, Power Platform, Oracle, and Informatica integration pathways. Specific governance details will be coordinated after award.
14–15	Section II, PWS §4.2.5 – Dashboard and Reporting Requirements	PWS §4.2.5 references forecasting, predictive analytics, and data science techniques. Can the Government clarify the intended analytical maturity level anticipated under this requirement, particularly whether expectations are centered on advanced business intelligence/reporting capabilities or broader predictive analytics modernization initiatives?	The PWS requires data science techniques for forecasting, predictive models, risk identification, and data-driven decision support; offerors should propose methods that meet these outcomes using appropriate tools.
11–15	Section II, PWS §4.2 – SLA Requirements	To support transition planning and operational continuity, can the Government provide additional context regarding current incident management, service request handling, and enhancement intake processes, including any enterprise ITSM governance requirements applicable to contractor operations?	The PWS identifies AWARE help desk, service requests, enhancements, escalation, and status reporting requirements. It does not name a separate enterprise ITSM governance process.
11–15	Section II, PWS §4.2 – SLA Requirements	Can the Government clarify whether SLA performance metrics apply during standard business hours only or whether after-hours, weekend, and federal holiday support coverage is required?	The PWS specifies AWARE help desk hours of 8:00 AM-5:30 PM ET. No separate after-hours coverage requirement is identified in the PWS.
10–16	Section II, PWS §4.2 – Technical Support Services	To support operational alignment and transition planning, can the Government provide additional insight into existing deployment governance, change management, and approval practices applicable to SharePoint Online, Power Platform, and reporting solution updates?	The PWS requires testing, documentation, IT and Government coordination for production deployments. Specific change approval practices will be coordinated after award.
21–38	Section II, PWS – Governance & Compliance Requirements	Can the Government clarify whether the contractor will be responsible for records management configuration, retention labeling, and eDiscovery support within Microsoft 365 environments?	The PWS requires governance support for policy, records retention, and CUI. It does not separately identify eDiscovery support unless directed within the contract scope.
14–19	Section II, PWS §4.2.5 – Reporting Requirements	Can the Government clarify whether the contractor will be expected to create executive-level KPI reporting frameworks and procurement analytics metrics, or whether standardized reporting templates already exist?	The PWS requires development and maintenance of executive dashboards, analytics, forecasting, KPI-style measures, and reporting tools. Existing templates/artifacts will be coordinated after award as applicable.
5	PWS 4.1.1 Kickoff Meeting – “accounting period end dates”	PWS 4.1.1.4 requires the Contractor to provide “the accounting period end dates to be used for the term of this award,” but does not define the accounting periods (invoice periods vs reporting periods vs fiscal periods). Please confirm what “accounting period end dates” means in this context and whether the Government requires a specific reporting calendar (e.g., monthly periods aligned to calendar month or to Treasury/IRS accounting periods).	The PWS requires the Contractor to provide proper accounting periods which align to monthly periods with calendar months, and the federal fiscal year calendar.

13	PWS 4.2.5 OCPO Visualization & Data Analysis – “data science techniques… forecasting… predictive models”	The PWS requires use of “data science techniques” to conduct forecasting and build predictive models, but does not define the expected technical depth. Please clarify whether the Government expects advanced machine learning model development (beyond native Power BI/Excel forecasting capabilities), or whether deterministic/statistical forecasting implemented using Power BI/Excel (e.g., DAX/Power Query, standard forecasting methods) is sufficient to meet Task 4.2.5 expectations.	The PWS requires data science techniques for forecasting, predictive models, risk identification, and data-driven decision support; offerors should propose methods that meet these outcomes using appropriate tools with the skillset to achieve those outcomes.
17	PWS 5.0 Deliverables Schedule – “PWS Section 4.2.4 SharePoint” row	In the PWS deliverables schedule, the row for “PWS Section 4.2.4 SharePoint” lists response/resolution timelines, but the Method and Recipient fields appear blank. Please confirm the required submission/communication method for CRS service request response/resolution metrics (e.g., CRS system entries, weekly report, monthly report) and the designated recipient(s) for any associated reporting.	CRS response/resolution activity should be tracked through the applicable Government service request process and reported/escalated to the Government Technical Lead consistent with the PWS. Method/recipient details will be coordinated after award.
20	PWS 9.0 Place of Performance + PWS/Section 11 Security Requirements	PWS 9.0 states performance is primarily at the contractor site (remote), while Section 11 requires “all work defined in 4.2… on IRS equipment, behind the IRS firewall, and using IRS-provided email accounts.” Please clarify the intended operating model for remote work “behind the firewall” (e.g., VPN/VDI/remote desktop) and whether any development/documentation may be performed off-network (drafting) prior to uploading to IRS systems, or whether all work artifacts must be created/edited exclusively within the IRS environment.	The PWS states performance is primarily remote, but Task 4.2 work must be performed on IRS equipment, behind the IRS firewall, using IRS-provided email unless the COR gives written permission.
21–22	PWS 11 Security Requirements – File transfer and encryption	The RFQ states secure transfer is “presently… accomplished by submitting the files in a FIPS 104-2 compliant zip file using SecureZip, encryption, and strong password,” and also states the Government does not provide a SecureZip license. Please confirm the intended standard is FIPS 140-2 (vice “104-2”), and whether the Government will accept alternative FIPS-validated encryption tools (e.g., approved AES-256 encrypted containers) in lieu of SecureZip, provided the method meets IRS requirements.	Government can accept alternatives; any alternate method must meet IRS security requirements.
4–5 & 21–22	PWS §4.1.1 Kickoff Meeting (within 10 business days) + PWS §11 Security Requirements (background investigation readiness; staff-like access constraints)	Given (1) the kickoff meeting occurs within 10 business days of award and (2) contractor personnel must be ready to complete background investigation forms the day of award and operate under staff-like access/security constraints, please confirm whether the Government permits a phased staffing ramp during the first 30 days (e.g., core PM/SMEs Day 1 with additional personnel onboarding as access is provisioned), or whether the Government requires the full proposed staffing complement to be in place and fully performing on Day 1 of the period of performance.	The Government does not require a phased staffing ramp up by the contractor. Contractor is required to complete and submit background investigation documents starting after contract award.
7 & 17	PWS 4.1.3.1 Monthly Status Report vs Deliverables Schedule due date	PWS 4.1.3.1 states the Monthly Status and Progress Summary Report is due “no later than Thursday prior (or as otherwise directed by the COR) to the end of the month,” while the Deliverables Schedule states it is “submitted on the last Thursday of each month.” Please confirm which due-date rule governs (Thursday prior to month-end vs last Thursday), and whether the COR may direct an alternate schedule without formal modification.	The deliverables schedule states the Monthly Contract Status and Progress Summary Report is due on the last Thursday of each month, unless otherwise directed by the COR.
70–71	Instructions to Offerors – Initial Staffing Plan LoE unit conflict	Instructions to Offerors require the Initial Staffing Plan to include “prime versus subcontractor labor hours and cost by labor category,” while the Initial Staffing Plan template states LoE may be expressed in “hours or FTEs.” Please confirm whether the Government will accept FTE-based LoE entries, or whether the Initial Staffing Plan must be completed strictly in hours for all labor categories (base and option).	The PWS does not specify whether LOE must be in hours or FTEs. Offerors should follow the RFQ/Initial Staffing Plan instructions for the required LOE format.
8–9	PWS 4.2.2 AWARE – enhancement completion vs acknowledgment metrics	PWS 4.2.2 states enhancement requests must be “95%… completed by the agreed date (Contractor and Technical Lead),” while the Outcome section states “Enhancement/Policy requests shall be implemented no later than three days after receiving the request.” Please confirm whether the Government requires a fixed 3-day implementation SLA for all enhancements, or whether enhancements are delivered to an agreed schedule (with 95% on-time performance), and how to treat enhancements requiring greater effort than three days.	The PWS includes both a three-day implementation requirement for enhancement/policy requests and a 95% agreed-date completion metric. Offerors should plan to meet the three-day outcome unless the Government Technical Lead establishes an agreed alternate schedule.

8–9	PWS 4.2.2 AWARE – severity/escalation vs business hours coverage	PWS 4.2.2 states AWARE help desk support is during business hours (8:00am–5:30pm ET), but also states “Any issue pertaining to AWARE shall be brought to the Government Task Lead immediately (within 1–2 hours)” and calls out severe issues (e.g., tool not available). Please clarify whether the 1–2 hour notification/escalation requirement applies only during business hours or also after hours for severity-1 outages, and whether any on-call coverage is expected.	The PWS states AWARE help desk support is during 8:00 AM-5:30 PM ET. The 1-2 hour escalation requirement applies to AWARE issues within the support framework stated in the PWS primarly during business hours; no separate on-call requirement is identified.
13	13. Records Management	Is there currently an off the shelf, non-proprietary tool that the government uses to maintain all records? If so, can the government kindly provide the name of the tool?	The PWS requires governance support for policy, records retention, and CUI, but does not name any records management tool.